ALYSSA RUSONIK

1 Rue de la Libération, 78350, Jouy-en-Josas, France
alyssa.rusonik@hec.edu ◇ alyssarusonik.github.io
Canadian citizen ◇ Born: 10/2000

EDUCATION

PhD in Finance, HEC Paris — *2022-2027 (expected)*
Under the supervision of Jean-Edouard Colliard and Itzhak Gilboa

Junior Visiting Scholar, Nuffield College, Oxford — *April-May, 2025*
Under the supervision of Margaret Meyer

Visiting Student, Toulouse School of Economics — *March-April, 2025*
Under the supervision of Sébastien Pouget

BSc in Mathematics and Economics (minor in History), University of Toronto — *2018-2022*
Senior thesis under the supervision of Aloysius Siow

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Primary: Financial Economics, Decision Theory, Behavioral
Secondary: Economic and Financial History

REFERENCES

Jean-Edouard Colliard (Advisor)
HEC Paris
colliard@hec.fr

Thierry Foucault
HEC Paris
foucault@hec.fr

Itzhak Gilboa (Co-Advisor)
HEC Paris
gilboa@hec.fr

Larry Samuelson
Yale University
larry.samuelson@yale.edu

Irina Zviadadze
HEC Paris
zviadadze@hec.fr

JOB MARKET PAPER

"Narrative Cacophony in Financial Markets" **(Job Market Paper)**

Awards: AF2I (French Association of Institutional Investors) Young Researcher Grant

Abstract: I develop a methodology for extracting "narratives – endogenously-emerging interpretational patterns – from unstructured text. I define "narrative cacophony" as the presence of many salient narratives with contradictory pricing implications. Applying the methodology to 21,771 news articles from the 2025 tariff "Liberation Day" episode, I study how cacophony mediates the incorporation of public information. I document that cacophony dampens trade volume. Moreover, when there is less trade because of cacophony, narratives explain a smaller share of variation in daily returns. The incorporation of narrative information also slows and a delayed pricing-in effect obtains. Because markets update prices through agents' trades in the presence of disagreement, these findings

suggest that information that is difficult to interpret (gives rise to cacophonous narratives) is less well-incorporated by markets as agents are more reluctant to trade.

Presentations: 22nd Olin Finance Conference at Washington University in St. Louis (PhD session, 2026, scheduled); Tilburg University (Finance, 2026); Toulouse School of Economics (Finance, 2026; PhD Seminar, 2025); HEC Paris (Finance, 2026; Economics, 2026; 10th PhD Workshop in Memory of Denis Gromb, 2026); Future Finance Fest (2026); ICMS Workshop on AI and Economics (2026); Bocconi (Theory and Experiments Seminar, 2026); Time, Uncertainties and Strategies XI (2025); Beliefs, Narratives, and Memory Workshop (2025); Parisian Behavioral Economics Symposium (2025); Oxford (PhD Seminar 2025).

WORKING PAPERS

"Institutional Commitment and Economic Revival: Evidence from Palace-Building in Renaissance Rome"

Awards: Georges Gallais-Hamonno Prize in Historical Finance; Frank D. Lewis Memorial Prize in Economic History; Arthur Hosios Award.

Abstract: I study the recovery of the Roman economy following the papacys absence (1309-1377), specifically, an era of palace-building resulting in the construction of over 31% of palaces built in Roman history. Using a novel dataset, I show that the late-15th century palace-construction boom was triggered by credible institutional commitment. A reform of inheritance laws (1475) allowed prelates to bequeath their possessions, causing a significant increase of prelate palace-building. Initial prelate investment guaranteed the papacy would remain in Rome long-term, which eventually incentivized laymen to invest. I disentangle the effect of commitment to long-term presence from contemporaneous papal presence to show that the irreversibility of institutional change is a necessary condition for successful intervention.

Presentations: Paris School of Economics (Economic History Seminar, 2026); Ludwig Maximilian University of Munich (PhD Seminar, 2025); EEA Congress (2025); Oxford (PhD Seminar, 2025); ENS Paris-Saclay (CEPS Seminar, 2025); Toulouse School of Economics (PhD Seminar, 2025); Early Modern Rome V (2024); Sixteenth Century Society Conference (2024); Canadian Network for Economic History Conference (2024); CREST (Economics, 2024); HEC Economics PhD Conference (2023); "All in the Family" Conference in Honor of Aloysius Siow (2023); University of Toronto (PhD Seminar, 2022).

"Lexitarianism: A Needs-Based Approach to Public Policy" with Itzhak Gilboa and Larry Samuelson

Abstract: Utilitarian models typically do not attempt to distinguish between wants and needs, and they assume that all determinants of well-being are commensurate. In contrast, welfare policies seem to reflect these distinctions. We propose to bridge the gap between utilitarian theory and economic practice by introducing *lexitarianism*: the maximization of a vector of lexicographically-ordered welfare functions, as applied to needs. We propose a formulation of the social welfare problem based on the concept of a position and use it to axiomatize lexitarianism as well as its extensions to multiple time periods and uncertainty.

Presentations: Econometric Society European Winter Meeting* (2026, scheduled); D-TEA (2026); RUD (2026); Normative Economics and Economic Policy seminar* (2026).

*Presentation by coauthor.

WORK IN PROGRESS

"Prospective and Retrospective Valuation of Financial Information" with Yves Le Yaouanq and Peter Schwardmann [draft available upon request]

SEMINARS & CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Only own presentations listed.

2026: *Seminars:* PSE Economic History Seminar; Bocconi Theory and Experiments Seminar; TSE Finance; Tilburg Finance; HEC Paris Finance; HEC Paris Economics.

Conferences: ICMS Workshop on AI and Economics; D-TEA; RUD; Future Finance Fest; 10th HEC Paris Finance PhD Workshop in Memory of Denis Gromb; 22nd Olin Finance Conference at Washington University in St. Louis (PhD session, scheduled).

2025: *Seminars:* TSE-TSM PhD Workshop $\times$ 2; CEPS Seminar (ENS Paris-Saclay); Oxford Student Research Workshop in Micro Theory; Oxford Economic and Social History Graduate Workshop; HEC Paris Finance; LMU PhD Student Brownbag.

Conferences: Parisian Behavioral Economics Symposium; EEA Congress 2025; Beliefs, Narratives, and Memory Workshop; Time, Uncertainties and Strategies XI.

2024: *Seminars:* CREST Internal Seminar; HEC Paris.

Conferences: Regional and Urban Economics Seminar (PSE, Discussant); Sixteenth Century Society Conference; Early Modern Rome V.

2023: "All in the Family" Conference in Honour of Aloysius Siow (University of Toronto); HEC Economics PhD Conference (HEC Paris); Canadian Network for Economic History Conference.

2022: University of Toronto PhD Seminar.

HONORS & AWARDS

AF2I (French Association of Institutional Investors) Young Researcher Grant	*2026*
Georges Gallais-Hamonno Prize in Historical Finance	*2025*
Frank D. Lewis Memorial Prize in Economic History	*2023*
Arthur Hosios Award	*2022*
HEC Paris Scholarship of Excellence *(five-year scholarship)*	*2022*
HEC Paris Foundation Scholarship *(five-year scholarship)*	*2022*
Undergraduate Research Grant *(Department of Economics, University of Toronto)*	*2022*
Trinity College Experiential Funding *(research grant from the Provost's Experiential Fund)*	*2022*
Provost's Scholar *(University of Toronto)*	*2022*
University of Toronto Excellence Award *(research supervisor: Peter Cziraki)*	*2021*
Fraser-Crawford Scholarship *(three-time recipient)*	*2019, 2020, 2021*
Margaret Ronald Taylor and Thomas Paxton Taylor Scholarship in Mathematics	*2020*
Myrtle V. McCulloch Prize in Renaissance Studies *(two-time recipient)*	*2019, 2020*
Ruth Robinson Leberg Book Prize in Political Science	*2020*
Rita K. Teetzel In-Course Scholarship	*2019*
University of Toronto Scholar *(awarded to top 100 UofT students)*	*2019*
RBC Canadian Universities Program Scholarship *(awarded annually to 50 students)*	*2018*
UofT National Scholarship *(full four-year scholarship; awarded to up to ten students)*	*2018*

PRE-PHD PUBLICATIONS

"Restricted Invertibility of Continuous Matrix Functions," with Adrian Fan, Jack Montemurro, Pavlos Motakis, Naina Praveen, Paul Skoufranis and Noam Tobin.
Operators and Matrices, 2022, 16(4): 1191-1217.

TEACHING

GRADUATE COURSES

HEC Paris, Finance Department:

- Financial Markets (Lecturer) *2024*
- Financial Markets (Teaching Assistant) *2023*
- Financial Economics (Teaching Assistant) *2023*

UNDERGRADUATE COURSES

University of Toronto, Department of Mathematics:

- MAT137: Calculus with Proofs (Head Teaching Assistant) *2021-2022*
- MAT237: Multivariable Calculus with Proofs (Teaching Assistant) *2020-2022*
- MAT137: Calculus with Proofs (Teaching Assistant) *2019-2021*

RELEVANT WORK EXPERIENCE

- Research Assistant to Noémie Pinardon-Touati (Columbia University), *2022-2023*
- Fields Undergraduate Summer Research Program (Fields Institute) *July-August, 2021*
- Research Assistant to Peter Cziraki (University of Toronto) *May-August, 2021*
- Strategy Analyst, Bank of Montreal (BMO) *May-August, 2020*

LANGUAGES

English (native), Russian (native), French (fluent), Italian (intermediate).